

[PROJECT / PRODUCT] / FOUR-SQUARE CONSTITUTIONAL LETTERHEAD	[PROJECT VERSION] Four-Square Template v1.3
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PROJECT CONSTITUTION / CONTRACT / LETTERHEAD

FOUR-SQUARE RELEASE LINEAGE

main1 = repository first commit / immutable root reference

SPEC spec-v1.2	[LANE-A] [lane-a]-v1.2	[LANE-B] [lane-b]-v1.2	MEMORY memory-v1.2
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SPEC and MEMORY are fixed. The two middle lanes are project-defined and **SHOULD** remain stable across versions.

CONSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE

MUST / MUST NOT binding law	SHALL / SHALL NOT constitutional alias	SHOULD / SHOULD NOT strong guidance	MAY permitted option	EXCEPTION / WAIVER explicit departure
MISSION [MISSION]	CORE PRINCIPLE [CORE PRINCIPLE]		BOUNDARY [BOUNDARY / OUT OF SCOPE]	

CONSTITUTIONAL HIERARCHY / FORMS

CONSTITUTION → ARTICLES / LAWS → CONTRACTS → POLICIES → GUARDRAILS → RECOMMENDED PRACTICES → CHECKLISTS

The form label does not determine force; the normative keyword does.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

ID	FORM	FORCE	CLAUSE
LAW-TRACE-001	LAW	MUST	Material binding clauses MUST carry stable FORM-SCOPE-NNN identifiers and SHOULD map to observable evidence.
LAW-VERSION-001	LAW	MUST NOT	FSL template version and governed project version MUST NOT be conflated.
LAW-PROOF-001	LAW	MUST NOT	A conformance claim MUST NOT be generalized beyond the scope and environment actually proven.
LAW-SNAPSHOT-001	CONTRACT	MUST	An accepted Four-Square release MUST record the exact reviewed commits for SPEC, lane A, lane B and MEMORY.
LAW-MEMORY-001	LAW	MUST NOT	MEMORY MUST NOT create or amend law unless promoted into SPEC. MEMORY may remember law; MEMORY cannot make law.

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

CONFORMANT	CONFORMANT WITH EXCEPTION	NON-CONFORMANT	NOT YET PROVEN
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A **MUST** / **MUST NOT** deviation **MUST** be visible. An **EXCEPTION** / **WAIVER MUST** identify clause ID, scope, owner, rationale, evidence and review/expiry condition where applicable.

RELEASE LAW

Draft ≠ Tested ≠ Accepted ≠ Released. Claims **MUST** be scoped to evidence actually validated. An accepted release **MUST** record the exact four reviewed lane commits. The snapshot **MUST NOT** replace Git. One version, four squares, all green.

Four-Square Template v1.3 SPEC + MEMORY fixed	MUST / SHOULD / MAY force is explicit	main1 = immutable root main = accepted integration
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PAGE 2 — GOVERNANCE / DEVELOPMENT / EXCEPTIONS

Use when project complexity requires more than the one-page constitutional identity.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

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DEVELOPMENT GOVERNANCE — RECOMMENDED CHECKLIST

- ☐ Material work **SHOULD** use a checklist or equivalent visible plan.
- ☐ Each material binding clause **MUST** have a stable clause ID and **SHOULD** map to a verification item and observable evidence.
- ☐ Agents **MAY** perform Discover → Plan → Execute → Observe → Verify → Record with defined responsibilities.
- ☐ LAW-AI-001 — When normative intent is ambiguous, agents **MUST NOT** silently choose a stronger or weaker interpretation; they **MUST** surface the ambiguity for review.
- ☐ Existing assets **SHOULD** be classified explicitly as REUSE, INHERIT or REFERENCE when project-boundary assumptions could otherwise leak.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER PROTOCOL

CLAUSE	SCOPE	OWNER	RATIONALE	EVIDENCE	REVIEW / EXPIRY
[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

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PAGE 3 — AMENDMENT LAW / EVIDENCE LEDGER / CERTIFICATION

Use only for complex projects. Three pages is the maximum.

AMENDMENT LAW

Binding constitutional changes **MUST** be made in SPEC and versioned. MEMORY **MUST NOT** amend the constitution.
A breaking constitutional change **SHOULD** identify migration impact.
Changing a project-selected middle lane token **MUST** be a reviewed migration, not an incidental rename.
Non-normative examples and mnemonics **MAY** evolve without changing constitutional force.

CONFORMANCE EVIDENCE LEDGER

CLAUSE ID	CLAIM / SCOPE	ENVIRONMENT	EVIDENCE	RESULT
[LAW-001]	[CLAIM / ARTIFACT / WORKFLOW]	[HOST / VERSION]	[TEST / LOG / HASH]	[STATE]
[LAW-002]	[CLAIM / ARTIFACT / WORKFLOW]	[HOST / VERSION]	[TEST / LOG / HASH]	[STATE]
[LAW-003]	[CLAIM / ARTIFACT / WORKFLOW]	[HOST / VERSION]	[TEST / LOG / HASH]	[STATE]
[LAW-004]	[CLAIM / ARTIFACT / WORKFLOW]	[HOST / VERSION]	[TEST / LOG / HASH]	[STATE]

RELEASE CERTIFICATION

The exact SPEC / lane A / lane B / MEMORY commit IDs **MUST** identify the reviewed release snapshot.
The release snapshot **MUST NOT** replace Git; Git commit identity remains authoritative.
Every active **EXCEPTION MUST** be attached to scoped release evidence using CLAIM / SCOPE / ENVIRONMENT / EVIDENCE / RESULT.
Every generated page **MUST** show Four-Square Template v1.3 separately from the governed project version; the two **MUST NOT** be conflated.